[INCH-POUND]

A-A-2661
December 30, 1991

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
# BRUSHES, MUCILAGE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Federal Specification H-B-401C, which has been cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers requirements for brushes used to apply mucilage in general office use.

## 1. Salient Characteristics

A. The brushes shall be flat and without collar and rim (see Section 8, fig. 1) Sizes: 1 inch; and, 3 inch.

B. Materials used in brushes shall be in accordance with normal commercial practice.

C. The dimensions of the brushes shall be in conformance with Table I; and, the design shall approximate figure I.

D. The bristles shall be pig or hog bristle. All bristles shall be boiled or steamed, straightened and thoroughly cleaned. The bristle shall show no tendency to separate at the end or to flare out when the brush is dried after washing.

E. The handle shall be made of wood, hard rubber, or slow burning or flame proof plastic. Plastic of cellulose nitrate composition shall not be acceptable. Wood handles shall be smoothly finished with varnish, lacquer or paint.

F. The ferrule shall be made of steel, the steel shall be nickel plated, a minimum of 0.0001 inches thick (certificate of compliance shall be provided).

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7510

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G. Bristles shall be set in rubber, brushmaker's pitch, epoxy resin compound or other suitable setting material which will not become brittle or be affected by the material with which the brushes are intended to be used. The setting material used shall be sufficiently secure to prevent removal of the bristles from the brush part of the setting compound without breaking the bristles when tested as specified in section 3. Handle, ferrule, and bristle shall be rigidly secured together.

Workmanship. Bristles shall not become detached from the brush under normal usage. Brushes shall be free from defects in material and workmanship which may affect appearance or serviceability.

2. Tables and Test Methods

TABLE I

| Brush; components<br>(Minimum - inches) | Size 1 inch | Size 3 inch |
|---|---|---|
| Ferrule: | | |
| Length | 1-1/4 | 1-1/4 |
| Thickness | 0.010 | 0.010 |
| Bristle: | | |
| Width inside ferrule | 1 | 3 |
| Length outside ferrule | 1-1/2 | 2-1/4 |
| Thickness inside ferrule | 5/16 | 3/8 |
| Hold in ferrule | 1/4 | 1/4 |
| Handle: | | |
| Length | 4-1/2 | 5-3/8 |
| Diameter | | |
| Overall length | 7-5/16 | 8-3/4 |



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A. Resilience Test (Washing)
The brush shall be washed in warm (60° - 90°F) tap water. After washing, the excess water shall be shook from the bristles. The brush shall be hung by the handle and air dried at room temperature (60° - 80°F). After drying, there shall be no evidence of flaring or fraying.

B. Bristle Test Individual strands of bristle shall be held between the thumb and forefinger and pulled until breaking. The setting material used, shall secure the bristles to the setting compound until this breakage occurs. A random sampling of (5) bristles across the brush shall be tested. If bristle pull out occurs before bristle breakage, then the brush fails the test requirements.

3. Quality Assurance

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

Sampling and Examination. Each lot of brushes shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the plans specified below.

A. Sampling for visual examination - Inspection Level S-4 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one brush.

B. Sampling for dimensional examination - Inspection Level S-1 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one brush.

C. Sampling for testing - Inspection Level S-2 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one brush.

D. Packaging, Packing, and Marking - Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container.



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4. Recovered Materials

The offeror/ contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580,to the maximum extent practicable.

5. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein: The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

MIL STD 105 is available from Naval Publications and Forms Center; 5801 Tabor Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19120.

Public Law 94-580, Resource Conservation and Recovery Act, is part of U.S. Code, Title 42. Available from congressional sales office, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington,D.C. 20402.

6. Preparation for delivery

Packaging and packing of the binders shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see section 7).

7. ORDERING DATA:

Ordering activities should specify the following:

(1) Size.
(2) Packaging, packing and marking.



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8. Figure

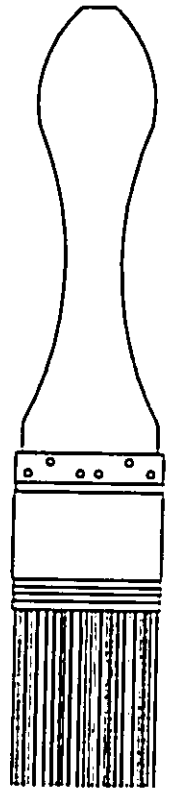


FIGURE 1

MILITARY INTERESTS:
None Registered

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS



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